

LAB 1 - AI Prompting Lab

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1. Novice vs Power User

Briefing makes the answer specific rather than general.

2. Knows vs Guesses

If you do not ask AI whether it is guessing, it often gives a confident answer. Users should also understand what AI can answer accurately and where uncertainty exists.

3. The 3 Retrieval Modes

Not only words like research and cite make AI search. It also depends on the type of question. Questions requiring fresh information are more likely to trigger web search.

4. Context Is Everything

A generic question produces a generic answer. Providing personal and relevant context helps the AI generate more useful responses.

5. Think Hard

Think Hard is most useful for decision-making and comparisons. For questions with a single straightforward answer, it provides little additional value.

6. Stop the Flattery

AI often agrees with assumptions already present in a question. Using compare or evaluate encourages more balanced responses.

7. Brainstorm–Iterate Loop

Just like human interaction, feedback improves outcomes. Iteration helps generate better answers and supports better decisions.

8. Multimodal – Image & Audio

AI can make mistakes with numbers and small details. Let AI handle most of the work and spend your effort verifying the critical parts.

9. Build a Small App

The 10-80-10 approach works well. AI can build most of the application quickly while the user focuses on planning and verification. Example: Snake Game.

10. Data Analysis

The answers were similar, but the first response did not show any code. The second response included code, making the results more trustworthy.

11. Desktop Apps & Permissions

Overwrite and delete permissions should not be granted on day one. Follow the 10-80-10 rule and understand the work before approving changes.

12. Which Model When

Different AI tools produced slightly different plans. Comparing answers across tools improves confidence and helps identify weaknesses.

13. Models Checking Models

Different models identify different gaps. One model may catch issues between real-world situations and abstract explanations that another model misses.

Conclusion

This lab demonstrated the importance of context, verification, iteration, and critical thinking when using AI systems. Better prompts generally lead to better responses, while validation and comparison help reduce mistakes.